



Aardwolf
Proteles cristata

- ↔ 26 in (67 cm)
- 📍 E. and S. Africa
- ⊗ Locally common

This small, striped relative of the hyenas has the typical hyena body form, with short hindlegs and a sloping back, exaggerated by a crestlike mane on its back. But it is much more lightly built, with small teeth, and instead of scavenging for carrion, it preys almost exclusively on termites. Hiding in a burrow by day, it emerges at dusk to search the dry grasslands for harvester termites, which it licks up from the ground with its long, sticky tongue.

Other species

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- European badger
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- European pine marten
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- Fosa
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- Galapagos sea lion
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Hoofed mammals
Orders Perissodactyla/Artiodactyla

Tibetan wild ass
Equus kiang

- ↔ 7–8 ft (2–2.4 m)
- 📍 W., C., and S. Asia
- ⊗ Common

Native to the deserts of central Asia, this relative of the domestic horse is specialized for life in dry habitats. It is a nomad that wanders the arid lands in herds looking for food such as grass and succulent desert plants. The herds are made up of females and their young, or bachelor males; the mature males are more solitary.



African wild ass
Equus africanus

- ↔ 7–8 ft (2–2.4 m)
- 📍 NE. Africa
- ⊗ Critically endangered

The probable ancestor of the domestic donkey, with a similar gray coat and a dark, bristly mane, the African wild ass lives in rocky east African deserts where the temperature on the ground can exceed a scorching 122°F (50°C). It survives by eating virtually any plant food it can find, from grasses to thorny acacia foliage and it is capable of going without drinking water for several days.

Plains zebra
Equus quagga

- ↔ 7–8 ft (2–2.4 m)
- 📍 E. to Southern Africa
- ⊗ Locally common

This is the most common and widespread of the zebras. It roams the African savannas in herds alongside wildebeest and gazelles, feeding mainly on grass. A typical zebra herd is made up of a male, his harem of females, and several young. The herds may stay together for several years, but the male must regularly fight off challenges from the younger males that live in their own bachelor herds.